

Chapter 178 Part 1: Extra Story 1-1

The year Xu Qingzhu gave birth to Chaochao and Mumu, and before Chaochao and Mumu turned two years old, Liang Shi took on very little work.

She basically turned down all dramas, except for those filmed near Haizhou City where she could return home every day—she didn't accept any others.

To her, family was more important than work.

She already felt guilty about not being able to share the burden of childbirth with Xu Qingzhu, so she could only try to make up for it after the two little ones were born by giving Xu Qingzhu enough space for work and life.

But the two little ones were still more attached to Xu Qingzhu.

Especially Shen Xuan.

So much so that when Xu Qingzhu occasionally held video meetings in the study, crying would often be heard from the room, or after Shen Xuan learned to walk, she would suddenly appear in Xu Qingzhu's video frame without warning, greatly distracting everyone's attention.

Sometimes when Xu Qingzhu was in a particularly important meeting, she would lock the door. Shen Xuan would then sneak to the study door when Liang Shi wasn't paying attention, first patting with one small hand, calling out in a milky voice: "Mommy~ open the door."

Xu Qingzhu was especially sensitive to their voices. Even while wearing earphones in a meeting, she would instantly recognize their voices and would get distracted for half a second to send Liang Shi a message: 【SOS! Your daughter is here again!】

After Liang Shi received the message, she would immediately rush to the study door.

Thus, Xu Qingzhu's ears would receive dual audio channels.

One ear had staff members reporting the situation, while the other ear without the earphone would hear Liang Shi and Shen Xuan's voices.

Liang Shi would lower her voice to coax: "Baby, come back to the room with Mama. Mommy is working, we can't disturb her, okay~"

When talking to children, she would always use sentence-final particles.¹

And it was even more excessive than when she used to talk to Ling Dang and the others.

Xu Qingzhu, as someone who especially loved hearing Liang Shi speak in a soft voice, sometimes couldn't stand it.

But the children loved it.

Even their children, who knew whom they took after, were each better at acting cute than the last!

Even through the door, Xu Qingzhu could imagine Shen Xuan's expression—she must be pouting, looking at Liang Shi with an aggrieved expression, blinking at her with eyelashes that were long and dense, curled and upturned.

Both daughters inherited Liang Shi's eyes, both having light brown pupils, but the eye shape was exactly the same as Xu Qingzhu's.

They had completely inherited the best features of both.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were already considered good-looking.

But the two little ones showed signs of surpassing their parents.²

So when they acted cute, it was especially irresistible.

"Mama." Shen Xuan would extend her milky-white little hand, tugging at Liang Shi's hem, "Just one look~ pretty please?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"How about waiting until Mommy finishes her meeting before looking, okay?" Liang Shi tried to negotiate with her.

Shen Xuan continued tugging at her hem, acting cute, "Wuwuwu~"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi would keep making "shh" gestures at her, but this trick obviously didn't work.

At this point, Chaochao would walk over, furrowing her brow despite her young age: "Please, can you be more obedient."

Shen Xuan huffed: "No!"

Chaochao sighed: "Mama, you really can't keep spoiling her!"

"Of course Mama has to spoil me! I'm her little cutie!" Shen Xuan put her hands on her hips, "Hmph!"

Chaochao looked at Liang Shi and asked seriously: "Mama, you said I was your only little cutie."

Liang Shi: "....."

SOS!

And so what started as Shen Xuan looking for Mommy evolved into the two little ones competing for affection, each one tugging at one of Liang Shi's arms, swaying Liang Shi back and forth.

Afraid of disturbing Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi picked one up in each arm and went back to the bedroom.

The two little ones continued competing for affection.

Chaochao: "Mama, tell me, who is your favorite baby?"

Mumu: "It's definitely me!"

Chaochao: "No, Mama said it was me last time!"

Mumu: "Then Mommy's favorite must be me!"

Liang Shi put them both on the bed, was silent for two seconds, then answered seriously and firmly: "Your Mommy's favorite person is me."

Chaochao & Mumu: "?"

After saying this, Liang Shi suddenly felt a bit embarrassed—competing for affection with two kids was beneath her dignity!

Especially since these two were her own daughters.

Just as she was about to say something to make up for it, she heard a low laugh from behind.

Xu Qingzhu had been so disrupted by Shen Xuan that she couldn't continue the meeting, so she had to end it early. Then she came over and heard their conversation.

She couldn't help but laugh.

When Liang Shi turned around, she saw a smiling face. Shen Xuan immediately ran over to hug her leg, her chubby little face pressed against Xu Qingzhu's leg and rubbing against it, her milky voice soft and sweet, drawing out the tone: "Mommy~ I missed you so much!"

"I only left for ten minutes." Xu Qingzhu bent down and pinched her face, "If you don't listen to Mama again next time, I'll spank you."

Xu Qingzhu deliberately put on a stern face, but Shen Xuan wasn't scared at all. "I just missed you, what did I do wrong?"

Liang Shi: "?"

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

A few seconds later, Xu Qingzhu asked Liang Shi: "What have you been showing her?"

Liang Shi: ".....Nothing at all!"

Chaochao tattled from the side, "Mama was looking at a script earlier and read some lines out loud."

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were simultaneously speechless.

Liang Shi shook her head, both helpless and stunned: "No wonder that line sounded so familiar."

Xu Qingzhu also poked Shen Xuan's head, "So young yet so cunning."³

Shen Xuan corrected her matter-of-factly: "Mommy, the phrase is 'mischievously clever.'"⁴

Children under five always managed to say surprising things.

The younger sister was more lively than the older sister, and also more mischievous.

Even though they were identical twins and looked very similar, when taken out, you could almost tell at a glance which one was the older sister and which one was the younger sister.

Chaochao always gave off a feeling of being more mature than her peers.

Liang Shi felt it was like how Rainbow initially made her feel.

Except she was better at acting cute than Rainbow.

She even specifically asked Zhou Li what Rainbow was like at this age.

What Zhou Li described was almost exactly like Chaochao's current situation.

-
1. In Chinese, "语气词" (yǔqì cí) refers to sentence-final particles that convey tone or emotion, such as "呀," "啊," "哦," "嘛," etc. These particles soften speech and add emotional nuance, commonly used when speaking affectionately or to children. ⇐
 2. The original phrase "青出于藍勝于藍" (qīng chū yú lán shèng yú lán) is a Chinese idiom meaning "the student surpasses the master" or literally "blue comes from indigo but is bluer than indigo." Here it means the children are even more beautiful than their already good-looking parents. ⇐
 3. The original phrase "人小鬼大" (rén xiǎo guǐ dà) literally means "small person, big ghost/demon" and is used to describe a child who is young but surprisingly clever, cunning, or street-smart beyond their years. ⇐
 4. The phrase "古靈精怪" (gǔ líng jīng guài) means mischievously clever or quirky in an endearing way, with more positive connotations than the previous phrase. ⇐